Lesson 15

FELLOWSHIP

Aim: To share the importance of fellowship as part of the basic principle of growth - its scriptural view and practical application.

Introduction: *"No man is an Island" is a saying that is true even in our Christian experience. God has created us as social and gregarious beings. We need other people to fellowship with in order to have a balanced and wholesome personality.*

I. MEANING OF FELLOWSHIP

A. The Greek word for Fellowship is " Koinonia" which means "sharing something in common with someone else". It is a partnership, a participation, and partaking of something together.

B. Scripturally, fellowship is a dynamic relationship between or among Christians whose bond is brought about by a common commitment to Jesus Christ.

II. WHY FELLOWSHIP IS IMPORTANT

A. To fulfill the prayer of Jesus for unity. John 17

B. To fulfill the command of Jesus to love one another John 13: 34,35

C. To fulfill the admonition to gather and encourage one another. Hebrews 10:25 - Example: Firewood or Broom

III. PRACTICAL SUGGESTIONS WHEN FELLOWSHIPPING

A. First, pray that God will lead you to the people or church whom to fellowship with.

B. Fellowship regularly - close relationship is established

C. Fellowship with pure motive - Christ is the center or Focus

D. Fellowship With openness and honesty - James 5:16

E. Fellowship with desire to share and participate - Galatians 6:10

F. Fellowship with Meek and humble heart - Ephesians 5: 21

G. Fellowship with the attitude of love, acceptance and forgiveness. - Romans 12:9-16

CONCLUSION

God does not want us to be alone. It is His will that we involve or relate with other Christians for our own spiritual growth.